

BS-CH101 / BS-CH201 — Chemistry-I

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Module 2 Exam Notes: Spectroscopic Techniques and Applications

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1. Spectroscopic Techniques and Applications

Spectroscopy is the study of interaction between electromagnetic radiation and matter. It is used to identify molecules, determine structure, and study energy-level transitions.

1.1 Basic Principle and Selection Rules

When radiation of frequency ν is absorbed or emitted, a molecule moves between two energy levels.

Energy of Radiation

$$\Delta E = h\nu = \frac{hc}{\lambda}$$

where h is Planck's constant, ν is frequency, c is speed of light, and λ is wavelength.

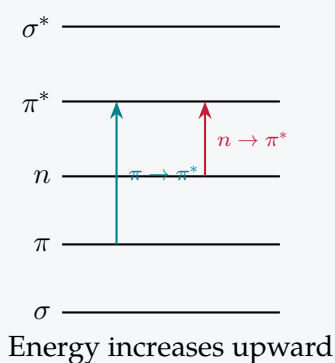
A transition is allowed only when it satisfies the required selection rule and has a changing electric or magnetic moment.

Technique	Energy change	Common selection rule
Rotational	Molecular rotation	$\Delta J = \pm 1$
Vibrational	Bond vibration	$\Delta v = \pm 1$ for fundamental transition
Electronic	Electron promotion	Spin and symmetry allowed transitions are intense
NMR	Nuclear spin orientation	Nuclei must have non-zero spin

1.2 Electronic Spectroscopy

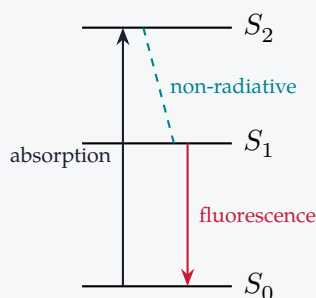
Electronic spectroscopy uses UV-visible radiation. It involves transitions such as $\sigma \rightarrow \sigma^*$, $n \rightarrow \sigma^*$, $\pi \rightarrow \pi^*$, and $n \rightarrow \pi^*$.

Common Electronic Transitions



1.3 Fluorescence and Medical Applications

Fluorescence occurs when a molecule absorbs light and quickly emits lower-energy light. It is useful in diagnostics, bio-imaging, and detection of trace biomolecules.

Jablonski Diagram for Fluorescence**1.4 Vibrational and Rotational Spectroscopy**

IR spectroscopy studies molecular vibrations. A vibration is IR active if it changes dipole moment. Rotational spectroscopy is observed mainly for gas-phase polar molecules.

Vibrational Frequency of a Diatomic Molecule

$$\nu = \frac{1}{2\pi} \sqrt{\frac{k}{\mu}}, \quad \mu = \frac{m_1 m_2}{m_1 + m_2}$$

where k is force constant and μ is reduced mass.

1.5 NMR, MRI, Surface Characterisation, Diffraction

NMR detects nuclei in a magnetic field. MRI is a medical imaging application of NMR, mainly using hydrogen nuclei in water and fat. Surface characterisation methods such as XPS, SEM, and AFM help study surface composition and morphology. Diffraction and scattering reveal crystal structure, particle size, and defects.

Bragg Equation

$$n\lambda = 2d \sin \theta$$

Here d is interplanar spacing and θ is the Bragg angle.

Exam Points

- Mention the energy region: microwave for rotational, IR for vibrational, UV-visible for electronic.
- In fluorescence answers, draw the Jablonski diagram.
- For NMR/MRI, write the need for non-zero nuclear spin.
- For X-ray diffraction, Bragg equation is compulsory.

2. Detailed Spectroscopy Notes for Exam Answers

2.1 Electromagnetic Spectrum and Type of Transition

Each spectroscopic method works in a particular energy region. In exam answers, first identify the radiation region, then the molecular transition.

Region	Approximate wavelength / frequency	Transition observed
Radiofrequency	MHz range	Nuclear spin transitions in NMR
Microwave	1 mm to 1 m	Rotational transitions
Infrared	4000–400 cm^{-1}	Vibrational transitions
Visible / UV	800–200 nm	Electronic transitions
X-ray	Very short wavelength	Diffraction by crystal planes

2.2 Beer-Lambert Law in Electronic Spectroscopy

UV-visible spectroscopy is often used for concentration measurement. If monochromatic light passes through a solution:

$$A = \log \frac{I_0}{I}$$

where I_0 is incident intensity and I is transmitted intensity.

Beer-Lambert Law

$$A = \epsilon cl$$

where A is absorbance, ϵ is molar absorptivity in $\text{L mol}^{-1} \text{cm}^{-1}$, c is concentration in mol L^{-1} , and l is path length in cm.

Solved Example: Absorbance

If $\epsilon = 2.0 \times 10^4 \text{ L mol}^{-1} \text{cm}^{-1}$, $c = 1.0 \times 10^{-5} \text{ mol L}^{-1}$, and $l = 1 \text{ cm}$:

$$A = \epsilon cl = (2.0 \times 10^4)(1.0 \times 10^{-5})(1) = 0.20$$

So the solution has absorbance 0.20.

2.3 IR Spectroscopy: Functional Group Region

IR spectra are very useful for identifying functional groups. The fingerprint region helps confirm identity, while the functional group region gives quick structural clues.

Bond / group	Typical range	Exam identification
O–H stretch	3200–3600 cm^{-1}	Broad band for alcohols and acids
N–H stretch	3300–3500 cm^{-1}	Amine or amide indication
C=O stretch	1650–1800 cm^{-1}	Strong sharp carbonyl peak
C=C stretch	1600–1680 cm^{-1}	Alkene or aromatic ring
C–O stretch	1000–1300 cm^{-1}	Alcohol, ether, ester

2.4 NMR Chemical Shift and Splitting

In proton NMR, chemical shift tells the electronic environment. Spin-spin splitting tells the number of neighbouring equivalent protons.

NMR Splitting Rule

If a proton has n equivalent neighbouring protons, its signal is split into:

$$n + 1 \text{ peaks}$$

The relative intensities approximately follow Pascal's triangle.

Proton type	Typical chemical shift	Reason
Alkyl R – CH ₃	0.8–1.5 ppm	Shielded environment
Near electronegative atom	3–4.5 ppm	Deshielding by O, N, halogen
Aromatic proton	6.5–8 ppm	Ring current effect
Aldehydic proton	9–10 ppm	Strongly deshielded

2.5 Bragg Law Derivation Idea

Constructive interference occurs when the path difference between X-rays reflected from successive crystal planes is an integral multiple of wavelength.

$$\text{Path difference} = AB + BC = 2d \sin \theta$$

For constructive interference:

$$n\lambda = 2d \sin \theta$$

This equation is used to calculate interplanar spacing d from diffraction angle.

Solved Example: Crystal Plane Spacing

For first-order reflection, $\lambda = 1.54 \text{ \AA}$ and $\theta = 30^\circ$:

$$d = \frac{n\lambda}{2 \sin \theta} = \frac{1.54}{2 \sin 30^\circ}$$

$$d = \frac{1.54}{1} = 1.54 \text{ \AA}$$

Answer-Writing Pattern for Spectroscopy

1. State the radiation region and energy transition.
2. Give the selection rule or activity condition.
3. Draw the transition diagram if possible.
4. Mention one analytical or medical application.

5. For numerical questions, write units clearly.

2.6 Rotational Spectroscopy of a Rigid Diatomic Molecule

For a rigid rotor, rotational energy levels are quantized:

$$E_J = \frac{h^2}{8\pi^2 I} J(J+1), \quad J = 0, 1, 2, \dots$$

where $I = \mu r^2$ is moment of inertia, μ is reduced mass, and r is bond length.

Rotational Spectral Lines

In wavenumber units:

$$\bar{\nu} = 2B(J+1), \quad B = \frac{h}{8\pi^2 I_c}$$

Successive lines are equally spaced by:

$$\Delta\bar{\nu} = 2B$$

Solved Example: Rotational Line Spacing

If the rotational constant of a molecule is $B = 5 \text{ cm}^{-1}$, then adjacent rotational spectral lines are separated by:

$$\Delta\bar{\nu} = 2B = 10 \text{ cm}^{-1}$$

2.7 Vibrational Spectroscopy and Hooke's Law Model

A diatomic molecule behaves approximately like two masses connected by a spring. Stronger bonds have larger force constant k and therefore absorb at higher wavenumber.

Factor	Effect on frequency	Reason
Higher force constant	Frequency increases	Bond is stiffer
Higher reduced mass	Frequency decreases	Heavier atoms vibrate more slowly
Hydrogen bonding	O-H/N-H peak becomes broad	Different bond strengths in association
Conjugation near C=O	C=O frequency decreases slightly	Partial single-bond character increases

2.8 Electronic Spectra: Bathochromic and Hypsochromic Shifts

Electronic absorption changes when substituents or solvents change the energy gap between molecular orbitals.

Term	Meaning	Simple interpretation
Bathochromic shift	Shift to longer wavelength	Energy gap decreases; red shift
Hypsochromic shift	Shift to shorter wavelength	Energy gap increases; blue shift
Hyperchromic effect	Increase in absorption intensity	More allowed transition or greater conjugation
Hypochromic effect	Decrease in absorption intensity	Less allowed transition or restricted structure

2.9 Fluorescence Versus Phosphorescence

Fluorescence and phosphorescence are both emission processes, but their lifetimes and electronic states differ.

Point	Fluorescence	Phosphorescence
Transition	Singlet to singlet	Triplet to singlet
Lifetime	Very short, about 10^{-9} – 10^{-7} s	Longer, milliseconds to seconds
Spin rule	Spin-allowed	Spin-forbidden, so slow
Observation	Stops quickly when source is removed	May continue after source is removed

Previous-Year Style Questions

1. Explain selection rules for rotational and vibrational spectroscopy.
2. Derive the expression for vibrational frequency of a diatomic molecule.
3. Explain fluorescence with Jablonski diagram and give medical applications.
4. State Beer-Lambert law and solve a concentration-based numerical.
5. Derive Bragg law and explain its use in crystal structure determination.

2.10 Short Notes on Surface Characterisation

Surface characterisation is used to study the outermost layers of solids, thin films, catalysts, sensors and biomaterials. These methods are important in engineering because surface properties often decide corrosion resistance, adhesion, catalytic activity and device performance.

Technique	Information obtained	Engineering use
SEM	Surface morphology and particle shape	Fracture surface, coating quality, microstructure
AFM	Nanometre-scale surface topography	Thin films, MEMS surfaces, biomaterials
XPS	Surface elemental composition and oxidation state	Corrosion films, catalysts, semiconductor surfaces
XRD	Crystal structure and interplanar spacing	Phase identification and crystallinity

Exam Answer: Why Surface Analysis Matters

Bulk composition may remain unchanged while the surface oxidizes, adsorbs impurities or forms a thin passive layer. Therefore surface techniques are needed to understand corrosion, catalysis, coating failure and sensor response.

Quick Revision — Module 2

Spectroscopic Techniques and Applications | BS-CH101

Key Formulas at a Glance

Formula / Rule	Meaning
$\Delta E = h\nu = \frac{hc}{\lambda}$	Photon energy absorbed or emitted in spectroscopy.
$\Delta J = \pm 1$	Rotational selection rule.
$\Delta v = \pm 1$	Fundamental vibrational transition rule.
$\nu = \frac{1}{2\pi} \sqrt{\frac{k}{\mu}}$	Diatomic vibrational frequency.
$\mu = \frac{m_1 m_2}{m_1 + m_2}$	Reduced mass of a diatomic molecule.
$n\lambda = 2d \sin \theta$	Bragg equation for diffraction.

One-Line Definitions

- **Spectroscopy:** Study of interaction of radiation with matter.
- **Selection rule:** Condition deciding whether a transition is allowed.
- **Chromophore:** Group responsible for UV-visible absorption.
- **Fluorescence:** Fast emission after electronic excitation.
- **IR active vibration:** Vibration causing a change in dipole moment.
- **Chemical shift:** NMR position relative to a reference.
- **Diffraction:** Constructive interference of waves scattered by ordered planes.

Frequently Asked / Viva Questions

Q1. What is spectroscopy?

It is the study of absorption, emission, or scattering of radiation by matter.

Q2. Write the relation between energy and wavelength.

$$\Delta E = hc/\lambda.$$

Q3. What is a selection rule?

It is a rule that decides whether a spectroscopic transition is allowed.

Q4. Why are rotational spectra shown by polar molecules?

Rotation must produce an oscillating dipole moment.

Q5. What is the condition for IR activity?

The vibration must change the dipole moment of the molecule.

Frequently Asked / Viva Questions (contd.)

Q6. What is fluorescence?

It is emission of light from an excited singlet state to the ground state.

Q7. Give one medical use of fluorescence.

Fluorescent probes are used in bio-imaging and disease diagnostics.

Q8. What is NMR based on?

Resonance absorption by nuclei with non-zero spin in a magnetic field.

Q9. How is MRI related to NMR?

MRI is an imaging technique based on NMR signals, mainly from hydrogen nuclei.

Q10. State Bragg law.

$$n\lambda = 2d \sin \theta.$$

Summary Reference Table

Method	Radiation / signal	Main application
UV-visible	Electronic transitions	Conjugation and concentration
Fluorescence	Emitted visible light	Medical imaging and trace analysis
IR	Vibrational transitions	Functional group identification
NMR/MRI	Nuclear spin resonance	Structure and medical imaging
XRD	Diffracted X-rays	Crystal structure